The Costume Eye

One film per sheet. Read the clothes as story — not as shopping.

Watched: _____
Where: _____
First time? ☐ yes ☐ rewatch

FILM	YEAR	DIRECTOR	COSTUME DESIGNER

1 THE PALETTE

Fill each box with pencil or paint, then name where it lives in the film

Which colour belongs to whom — and what happens the first time someone wears somebody else's?

2 WHAT THE CLOTHES SAID BEFORE ANYONE SPOKE

CHARACTER	SILHOUETTE & LINE	PALETTE	FABRIC, WEIGHT, TEXTURE	WHAT IT REVEALS — AND HIDES

3 WHAT CHANGED, AND WHAT REFUSED TO

SCENE OR BEAT	WHAT CHANGED ON THE BODY	THE STORY REASON FOR IT

Who changes the *least*? What is that stillness doing?

A garment that outlives its owner — passed on, borrowed, stolen, inherited?

4 CRAFT & MONEY

Every costume department is solving a budget in public

	WHAT I ACTUALLY SAW	WOULD I HAVE SOLVED IT THAT WAY?
Where the money went		
Where they hid that it didn't — repeats, doubles, backs never seen		
Ageing, dyeing, breakdown — what was done to the cloth		
Period as researched, or period as remembered?		

5 THE ONE GARMENT I WOULD STEAL

SKETCH IT

What it is, and why it works:

The one thing I would have done differently in this whole film:

VERDICT — THIS FILM GOES IN THE

☐ steal ☐ study ☐ avoid

One sentence I want to carry into my own work: